Investment Committee - Q4 Decision Basis

Decision mandate

Approve exactly one of P1, P2 or P3 for 1 October to 31 December 2026. Choose the feasible plan with the largest Q4 operating contribution after transition spending. Operating contribution here means contracted customer revenue less managed inference invoices, reserved GPU charges, shared platform overhead and transition spending. No tax, depreciation, financing or terminal value enters this quarter-only comparison. Shared platform overhead is USD 85000 each month, unchanged by the plan. Revenue in customer_forecast.csv is monthly contracted revenue, not per-request revenue.

Representative demand population

September is the representative 30-day demand month. A request is its highest available revision; retain only outcome completed. Account keys are case-insensitive after surrounding whitespace is removed. Quantities labelled ktokens are thousands of tokens; tokens are individual tokens. Forecast each account using its month-specific factor and the calendar day count divided by 30. Preserve fractional expected request and token counts until monetary reporting. Failed retry attempts do not create additional logical demand. Cancelled requests do not represent the completed service demand being forecast.

Routing and quotation authority

Choose the latest revision for each mapping identifier in deployment_options.csv. Match the current rules to customers through route_group, then verify the data class and use case. The current infrastructure offer is the highest revision within each offer identifier. Only award_eligible true quotations may support the approved resident workload. The eligible offer for each prospective month supplies that month's throughput, price, calendar hours and physical limit. Earlier revisions and ineligible pool quotations cannot be blended into an average commercial rate.

Replay evidence convention

Each benchmark row identifies a model and use case, its evaluated population and passes, batch p95 latency and planning factors. Quality is the ratio of all passes to all evaluated observations in the applicable cell. The cell latency measure is the maximum batch p95. The remaining replay factors use arithmetic means of their batch values. Benchmark batches are independent observations rather than versions of the same rule. Evaluate only deployed cells for a candidate plan, while applying the service requirements from the executed commercial terms.

Cost convention

For each request, output length is multiplied by its model/use-case replay output_length_factor. Expected input tokens billed are input tokens times (1 - eligible * cache_hit_fraction + retry_attempts_per_request). Expected output tokens billed are adjusted output tokens times (1 + retry_attempts_per_request * retry_output_fraction). Use arithmetic means of those replay factors per model/use-case cell. Local-L is billed only through its reserved pool, with no managed token charge. Retry and cache effects are not separate surcharges on top of those token quantities.

Resident capacity convention

For each September hourly bucket, aggregate Local-L output-equivalent tokens after applying the same cache and retry factors used above. Input tokens contribute the input_to_output_equivalent in the current infrastructure offer. Multiply each account contribution by the prospective month factor, but not by the calendar-day scaling factor: this is a representative hourly peak. Divide the largest hourly sum by 3600, throughput and headroom, round upward, and apply the minimum pool size. Reserve that GPU count for the entire respective calendar month. Do not offset a shortage in one hour with idle capacity in another.

Capacity eligibility and planning limits

The maximum_gpus field in the current eligible quotation is the physical pool limit for that month. A plan exceeding this limit is infeasible even when its average load would fit. The headroom fraction defines permitted utilisation, not spare capacity to subtract after rounding. A minimum reservation can exceed a low monthly requirement and remains payable. Calendar hours are the number of hours billed for the reservation, rather than the number of busy hours observed in the representative demand month.

Comparability and timing

Use identical subscription revenue and unchanged overhead assumptions for all proposals. Their differences arise from approved routes, corresponding inference activity, reserved hardware and transition spending. Charge each plan's transition quote once in October. Do not annualise quarter savings or deduct a hypothetical resale value. The recommendation must follow the stated contribution measure after checking feasibility. A provisional management preference, a vendor presentation or a calculated action label is not an alternative decision rule.

Reconciliation and limitations

Use September usage, not attempt-event counts, as demand. attempt_events.jsonl is the troubleshooting export for diagnosing the difference between attempt and request counts. Benchmark factors are planning assumptions, not proof that production behaviour will remain unchanged. No carbon offset or sunk historical infrastructure spending affects this decision. Distinguish record corrections from changes in the actual commercial scope. Where a material exception cannot be resolved from the supplied evidence, describe its effect rather than silently substituting an attractive assumption.

Administration and review

Retain all billing evidence. File each signed amendment. Record unresolved commercial questions. Do not assume automatic renewal. Operational owners should retain the original exports alongside any reconciled analytical tables used for committee review. A reference to a customer describes its account identifier and does not authorise disclosure of confidential information. Commercial comparisons should use the same quarter boundaries for every alternative and should identify material limitations. The committee may request supporting records whenever a reported amount cannot be traced to the supplied materials. Any later change to a quoted amount requires a new approval record before implementation can proceed. Procurement staff should record which version was accepted and retain the earlier correspondence for the audit trail. The presence of an earlier quotation does not establish that its conditions continue to govern the proposed purchase. No meeting note, informal preference, or provisional dashboard label constitutes approval of a deployment investment. Financial evidence should remain separate from promotional claims about prospective product capabilities or customer satisfaction. An unresolved discrepancy must be described rather than replaced with an unsupported estimate that favours a preferred plan. The review owner should distinguish an assumption changing the estimate from an error changing the calculation. Capacity forecasts remain conditional on workload shape and do not guarantee that production demand will follow historical patterns. If additional information arrives after the decision date, retain the original recommendation and document the updated comparison separately. A vendor name appearing in a register does not itself demonstrate contractual eligibility for the restricted workload. Where records share a commercial identifier, amendments should be interpreted in their effective order rather than their file position. Account managers may confirm customer commitments but cannot waive infrastructure controls on behalf of the security owner. Every reported cost should be attributable to a defined billing period, a stated unit, and a documented commercial obligation. The committee expects clear evidence of why the selected plan remains preferable after the other proposals receive equal treatment. Implementation teams should monitor the assumptions that matter to the decision instead of treating the approved estimate as permanent. A document retained for audit can be relevant background without being the controlling authority for the current period. Reviewers should not infer a contractual obligation solely from a numerical amount repeated in an operational export. The recommendation should distinguish commitments already executed from expenditure that would arise only after a plan is approved. Any future negotiation is a separate decision and must not be credited as a saving in the present comparison. The approval record should identify the responsible implementation owner and the conditions under which the committee will revisit its decision.